

Submission Worksheet

Submission Data

Course: IT265-002-S2026

Assignment: IT265 Case Study - Personal Choice

Student: Richie R. (rr257)

Status: Submitted | **Worksheet Progress:** 100%

Potential Grade: 10.00/10.00 (100.00%)

Received Grade: 0.00/10.00 (0.00%)

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Grading Link: <https://learn.ethereallab.app/assignment/v3/IT265-002-S2026/it265-case-study-personal-choice/grading/rr257>

View Link: <https://learn.ethereallab.app/assignment/v3/IT265-002-S2026/it265-case-study-personal-choice/view/rr257>

Instructions

Step 1: Pick a game you plan to analyze

Step 2: Playtest your game choice (or review streamers playing the game)

Step 3: Analyze, research, and review your chosen game. Collect resources (website links, etc that you used during the exploration) include these with the responses in the related sections. Fill in the responses of the below prompts/checklist/etc.

Step 4: Export the PDF. Upload it to Github and upload the same PDF to Canvas.

Section #1: (1.25 pts.) Game Overview

Progress: 100%

⇒ Task #1 (0.63 pts.) - Historical Context and Game Description

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Game's title, developer, publisher, platform, and release date.
- Historical context of the game's release and its place in the industry.
- Game's genre and how it compares to similar games of the time.

Your Response:

Minecraft, the original creator of Minecraft was Notch, and the publisher was Monjang studios and the platform was originally PC with Java and then later on ported to mobile and consoles. It was officially released on November 18, 2011, however it's

mobile and consoles. It was officially released on November 18, 2011, however, its initial public alpha release on May 17, 2009, and the game's release was during a time when big games were going crazy like Call of Duty and other games. In general the genre is a sandbox survival game and the games that were most similar were games like Terraria, Infiniminer being a big influence and Roblox.



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⇒ Task #2 (0.63 pts.) - Gameplay Mechanics

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Discuss the core gameplay mechanics and how they shape the player's experience.
- Explain how players control the game and interact with it.
- Identify and describe any unique aspects or creative elements in the game's gameplay.

Your Response:

The core gameplay mechanics of minecraft revolve around the fact that the game is a first person game with the optional ability to go into third person, you also can move and sprint and have a hunger and health bar, you can also jump and move in all directions. You can also click to either break or place items and or use them and look around with your mouse. All of these mechanics shape the player's experiences by being simple for anyone to pick up and start playing and making whatever their hearts desire. The players can also use these mechanics to control the game by beating mobs and getting items and progressing in the game in a way they see fit, usually by getting wood, iron and then getting diamonds, getting a home, food, and then going to the nether and then enchanting and then you usually go to the end, generally speaking that is the order. As such all the actions require the mechanics, for example because you can break blocks, you are able to utilize one of the most important mechanics which is crafting, and this can let you make tools or blocks to make your life easier, you also have the ability to freely break almost anything in the world which is definitely unique as well as being able to make almost anything.



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Section #2: (1.25 pts.) Software Architecture And Technology

Progress: 100%

⇒ Task #1 (0.63 pts.) - Technical Framework

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Describe the game engine and any special software (middleware) used to make the game. Explain why these were important for making the game work.
- List the programming languages and software tools used to build the game. Discuss how these tools helped in creating the game's features.

Your Response:

Minecraft was originally built in raw Java and using a Java Library called LWJGL, beyond this the initial game didn't really do anything else as it made a custom engine for itself. However, I will say that the later ports and other versions of minecraft were built with C++ to make it useable for other devices. The other versions were important because the devices at the time didn't follow support the same requirements that minecraft java had. Java was simply chosen because Notch the developer was familiar with Java.



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⇒ Task #2 (0.63 pts.) - Innovations and Challenges

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Identify and describe any new or unique technical features in the game. Explain how these features made the game different or improved it.
- Discuss any major difficulties the developers encountered while making the game. Describe how they solved these problems.

Your Response:

After doing some research, I found that minecraft uses Perlin Noise for procedural generation of the terrain which allowed the developers to have custom Terrain for each world but also because of the math it uses, a seed number would allow the same world to be generated if you used the same number. Another interesting conflict that occurred was the fact that Java relies on it's garbage collector to manage memory and so they couldn't just have every block be an object as this would be incredibly inefficient and so something they decided to do instead they stored the chunk data as a massive array of bytes and integers representing the block ID's and metadata.



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Section #3: (1.25 pts.) Gameplay Mechanics And Level Design

⇒ Task #1 (0.63 pts.) - Mechanics Analysis

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Explore and describe the main rules and actions that players use in the game. Explain how these core mechanics define the game's playstyle.
- Discuss how the game's core mechanics keep players interested and involved. Describe the ways these mechanics make the game fun or challenging.

Your Response:

Minecraft depends on a decent amount of rules, such as when you die, you drop your items, and you respawn at world spawn unless you set your spawn on a bed. There are also day and night cycles and mobs always spawn at night time and in the dark, and in order to prevent them from spawning you have to light up the area to prevent this. There are also rules like a wooden pickaxe can't mine a diamond ore, meaning there is some form of progression that is required. Also hunger goes down naturally and this makes the player need to either hunt animals or grow food in order to get their hunger bar back up. These core mechanics keep the player engaged by the fear of death and allow the player to directly control the combat against other mobs and making sure they are prepared for certain scenarios, like if you go mining make sure to bring enough food.



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⇒ Task #2 (0.63 pts.) - Level Design

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Describe the design of the game's levels or environments. Focus on the layout, obstacles, and visual elements, and how they contribute to the game's setting.
- Explain how the level or environment design affects the way players play the game. Discuss how these design choices impact the overall experience, such as creating challenges, guiding the player, or setting the mood.

Your Response:

Minecraft's Terrain is auto-generated and as such is always unique but similar for every new world, as such some consistency between is how biomes exist which have different structures, trees, blocks and unique looks and are several chunks long and wide, chunks being the side of a specific area in minecraft. The biomes and structures contribute to the game significantly by adding the feeling of exploring to be rewarded as well as just simply getting lucky and finding that one great location to make your

as well as just being getting really and making the game feel more alive with different terrains. The environment definitely affects how players play the game as it helps or distracts or forces the player to struggle depending if they go to a village or a really dense forest or a nice flatland or mountain area. All of which can contribute to mobs spawning to try to attack you or so you can attack certain mobs for food and or villagers to trade with. All of this sets the mood that the player is alone but the world is still alive and around them.



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Section #4: (1.25 pts.) Graphic And Audio Design

Progress: 100%

⇒ Task #1 (0.63 pts.) - Graphic and Audio Design

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Describe the game's visual appearance and the artistic choices made. Discuss elements like color, art style, and thematic consistency, and how they contribute to the game's overall look and feel.
- Discuss the design of the game's characters and environments. Focus on aspects such as realism, creativity, and how they fit within the game's world. Explain how these designs enhance the player's immersion in the game.

Your Response:

The game is a 3D block world and honestly it fits perfectly since the game takes advantage of this by making everything it can be blocky or pixelated. Take the mobs for example, they aren't complete squares, however, they are definitely blocky and fit the world and art style of the game. The color scheme and thematic consistency of blocks and colors like light blue to the sky both help the game tremendously, as such the game's environments are definitely based off reality but are creative in the sense that the world generation will sometimes create stuff that is just impossible in real life, like a floating island with a tree on it. The character being block and tall and being able to actually interact with the world plays a huge role in the player's immersion in the game.



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⇒ Task #2 (0.63 pts.) - Audio Design

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Examine the game's sound design, focusing on the music and sound effects. Describe how they are used and their quality. Discuss any memorable or unique audio elements in the game.
- Explain how the game's audio contributes to its overall mood and setting. Discuss how sound and music influence the player's emotional response and enhance the gaming experience.

Your Response:

The game sound design plays a huge role, with the most memorable thing about Minecraft, being its sound track, the game's music is calming but engaging and is quite literally perfect for this type of game. The actual sounds of the player getting hurt as well as the sounds of mobs and block breaking also significantly add to the engagement as it makes the game feel alive. There are also unique audios that can randomly play in the caves, which sound horrifying to the player and this is to spook the player and keep them engaged and scared. Overall, the game's audio contributes a lot because the soundtrack is amazing and keeps the player calm, especially when you are building and you just have peaceful background music from the game while you build. You keep doing this and eventually the music associates with that action!



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Section #5: (1.25 pts.) User Interface And User Experience

Progress: 100%

⇒ Task #1 (0.63 pts.) - User Interface and User Experience

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Describe the layout of the game's user interface (UI) and how it functions. Discuss elements like menus, icons, and on-screen prompts, and how they help players navigate and understand the game.
- Evaluate how well the game's UI communicates important information to players. Discuss aspects such as clarity, readability, and the ability of the UI to provide necessary game details without overwhelming or confusing the player.

Your Response:

The game's UI is very easy to understand, you have hearts to represent your health, you have pieces of meat to represent hunger, you have an empty hotbar to represent no ideas, and you also start with your fist in front of you, most likely to assist the player in understanding that they can probably do something with it. The actual UI of the inventory is very clean with armor plate and a mini player on the top left so you can

Inventory is very clean with armor slots and a mini player on the top left so you can see what you look like with armor, with a crafting section to the right, with the rest of the empty boxes for inventory space underneath. Then you have things like bubbles that appear above your hunger bar if you are underwater to show that you are holding your breath and you also have things like armor pieces to show that you are wearing armor on top of your hunger bar. The game's UI is basic but extremely effective at communicating important information, with eat food, heal up, don't die, and armor up.



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⇒ Task #2 (0.63 pts.) - UX Analysis

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Discuss the overall feel of playing the game, focusing on how different aspects of the game contribute to the player's experience. Analyze how these elements, such as ease of use, game flow, and feedback, affect the gameplay.
- Evaluate the design decisions made to enhance the player's experience. Consider factors like tutorial design, learning curve, and player engagement. Discuss how effective these choices are in making the game enjoyable and accessible to players.

Your Response:

The overall UX of minecraft is really good I would argue, it is flexible and you can change the GUI size very easy and it's clear what everything does, you have your health bar, hunger bar, and the XP bar could be argued as something that could be improved on, as it is not very clear, however the hotbar and the actual UI/UX of the inventory is very simply and clean as well as the armor slots and crafting section. I personally feel like the entire UX of the game is really straightforward and allows players to quickly pick up the game and test stuff and get used to play. I will say however, that the the UX of the settings is a little weird, and a little all over the place and won't be clear to know where you are trying to look. Overall, I'd rate it a 8/10 for UX design because of the problems with settings.



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Section #6: (1.25 pts.) Narrative And Storytelling

Progress: 100%

⇒ Task #1 (0.63 pts.) - Narrative Structure

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Describe the game's story, including its narrative structure, main plot points, and the setting in which it takes place. Discuss how these elements come together to create a cohesive and engaging story.
- Analyze the storytelling techniques used in the game, such as dialogue, cutscenes, or environmental storytelling. Evaluate how effectively these techniques convey the story and engage the player.

Your Response:

Minecraft being a survival sandbox at heart, technically does not have a clear storyline of any sorts. However, there is some story to follow with the achievements as well as the context clues left in the world. Take for example, pyramids in the desert obviously show that there was a civilization before that was advanced enough to make these structures. We also have things like the destroyed nether portals in the overworld which show that a prior civilization had tried to go to the nether and then left and destroyed the portal. We also have structures like villages and mansions and these showcase that the player is not alone with npcs like Villagers and Pillagers and other mobs. All these elements come together to create an engaging environment more so than a direct story, however, the player can sometimes create their own story with these elements. There is no dialogue or cutscenes, however, like I mentioned before the environmental storytelling is mostly up to interpretation and theories really.



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⇒ Task #2 (0.63 pts.) - Character and Integration

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Discuss the development of the game's characters. Describe their roles within the story, their personalities, and how they evolve throughout the game. Consider how the characters contribute to the overall narrative.
- Examine how the game's narrative and characters are integrated into the gameplay. Discuss how story elements are woven into the game mechanics and how this integration affects the player's experience.

Your Response:

The only real characters that have been officially added and named are Steve and Alex, both characters don't speak and simply just exist in the sandbox world, as such their story, personalities and evolution is essentially non-existent in this game. However, this allows the player's themselves to be the character and so they get to choose what occurs in the world. The games narrative and characters don't really matter in the sense of you could choose any name and any skin and minecraft would still be minecraft.



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Section #7: (1.25 pts.) Impact And Reception

Progress: 100%

⇒ Task #1 (0.63 pts.) - Reception and Impact

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Research and summarize how the game was received by critics and players. Include key reviews, ratings, and player feedback. Discuss any notable praise or criticism the game received.
- Analyze the game's impact on the gaming industry. Discuss how it may have influenced game design, trends, or inspired other games. Consider any lasting effects it has had on the industry.

Your Response:

Minecraft was received extremely well when it first dropped from both critics and players, this was because the game provided freedom to do quite literally anything you wanted. The game did receive some criticism that it was a little confusing as to how to achieve things, as in, there was no tutorial but I'd argue this was actually important as it let the player figure stuff out on their own. One of the most impactful concepts though about minecraft is that it popularized the idea of funding a game in it's early stages to get a full product later on. Also, because the game was extremely focused on player freedom and the sandbox feel, it was different and more importantly it was development independently meaning it was a indie game, this helped push people into making their own games! Lastly, it had lasting effects on the content creator communities, as games start to become popular this way now a days and minecraft was one of the first games to become popular this way!



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⇒ Task #2 (0.63 pts.) - Cultural Significance

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Examine the game's cultural significance and the legacy it has left behind. Discuss how the game has been remembered over time and its status in the gaming community.
- Describe the game's presence and representation in media, such as films, books, or online content. Discuss its role in fan communities and any influence it has had on broader cultural aspects, such as art, music, or social trends.

it has had on broader cultural aspects, such as art, music, or social trends.

Your Response:

Minecraft has had a significant cultural experience on everyone, and is commonly known as a game that people will randomly get the urge to play for 2-4 weeks straight and then take a massive break in between sessions, each time starting a new world and etc. The legacy of minecraft is definitely something people still look back on and play older versions, however, minecraft is still extremely popular and people still play it very frequently and as such the game is extremely memorable and is constantly referred to in the gaming community. The game's presence and representation in media is everywhere with references to even a whole movie being made about it which was also extremely popular, and there were also minecraft guide books to help players learn and practice. Overall though, the biggest presence of the game is the social media aspect, with video content related to the game being extremely influential.



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Section #8: (1.25 pts.) Reflection

Progress: 100%

⇒ Task #1 (0.63 pts.) - Describe your personal experience playing the chosen game

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Was it "fun"? What made it fun or not fun?
- Is this genre/game-type aligned with personal interests?
- What made you pick this game? Was it a good choice?

Your Response:

I love minecraft and I enjoy playing minecraft all the time, so yes it was very fun. The genre/game type definitely aligns with my personal interests as it allows me to freely play the world in a way I enjoy but also let's me very easily play with my friends and family which makes it even more fun, especially since I like exploring and building in this game. Overall, I picked this game because I wanted to learn a bit on the history and analyze the game from a game development perspective which definitely worked and taught me a lot and made me reconsider a lot of things I took for granted in the game.



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⇒ Task #2 (0.63 pts.) - Assignment Reflection

Details:

- What interesting or new "thing(s)" did you learn during your research and analysis?
- Did you find it was easy to come across the information you were looking for? What was your primary means of research/analysis?

Your Response:

Some interesting things I found was how minecraft generates it's terrain which was pretty cool since it's extremely useful for understanding how people can reverse engineer coordinates via bedrock patterns. Overall, I did find it really easy to find information because the history and analyzes on minecraft are great in number especially since minecraft is extremely popular and has been around since 2009.



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